You need JavaScript enabled to use this service.

Cookies on Civil Service Jobs

We use some essential cookies to make this website work.

To understand how you use Civil Service Jobs and improve the website we'd like to set some additional cookies.

7452911b2aa6e94096d364654c4da037.177

Accept additional cookies

Reject additional cookies

1775620384-8f15617ff332d0d5119e78cb948

change
Language
121
BQsDAAAABgoESm9icwAAAAlwYWdlY2xhc3N
1224
yes
1775620384-8f15617ff332d0d5119e78cb948

Junior Frontend Developer

Government Digital Service

Apply before 11:55 pm on Thursday 16th April 2026

Government Digital Service

Reference number

456462

Salary

£42,893 - £46,776

£42,893 - £46,776 Based on capability. The base salary of this grade is £42,382 Offers made above this will be made up with a specialist pay allowance.

Job grade

Senior Executive Officer

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

GDS - National Data Library

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

1

Contents

Location
About the job
Benefits
Things you need to know
Apply and further information

Location

Bristol, Manchester

About the job

Job summary

The Government Digital Service (GDS) is the digital centre of government. We are responsible for setting, leading and delivering the vision for a modern digital government.

Our priorities are to drive a modern digital government, by:

1. joining up public sector services
2. harnessing the power of AI for the public good
3. strengthening and extending our digital and data public infrastructure
4. elevating leadership and investing in talent
5. funding for outcomes and procuring for growth and innovation
6. committing to transparency and driving accountability

We are home to the Incubator for Artificial Intelligence (I.AI), the world-leading GOV.UK and at the forefront of coordinating the UK s geospatial strategy and activity. We lead the Government Digital and Data function and champion the work of digital teams across government.

We re part of the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (DSIT) and employ more than 1,000 people all over the UK, with hubs in Manchester, London and Bristol.

The Government Digital Service is where talent translates into impact. From your first day, you ll be working with some of the world s most highly-skilled digital professionals, all contributing their knowledge to make change on a national scale.

Join us for rewarding work that makes a difference across the UK. You'll solve some of the nation s highest-priority digital challenges, helping millions of people access services they need

Job description

Data.gov.uk is the public sector open data hub where users can search and browse for open data from across the public sector. We have an ambitious agenda to transform the way the public sector makes its data available and reusable. Transforming data.gov.uk plays a major role in this agenda as we redesign it into a modern reliable data hub which can provide access to a variety of public sector data.

As a Frontend Developer for data.gov.uk you'll share the responsibility for the ongoing operation, maintenance and continuing development of the data.gov.uk frontend.

As a Frontend Developer you will:

- build and maintain accessible, inclusive user interfaces using HTML, CSS and JavaScript, following WCAG guidance, GOV.UK Design System patterns and GDS web standards
- write clean, well-structured frontend code using a progressive enhancement approach, with support from more experienced developers
- develop and iterate prototypes and frontend components based on user needs, helping the team test and improve ideas early
- work closely with designers, user researchers and other developers to understand user needs and translate them into usable, high-quality interfaces
- test your code and help fix bugs and accessibility issues, contributing to automated testing and quality assurance activities
- support the ongoing operation of the data.gov.uk frontend by making small improvements, resolving issues and learning how services are supported in production
- consider performance, usability and maintainability when making changes, with guidance on improving page load times and frontend performance
- communicate your work clearly through code comments, documentation and team discussions, and share learning with the wider frontend community as you develop

Person specification

We re interested in people who:

- can write clear, well-structured frontend code that follows modern web standards and a progressive enhancement approach
- have a working knowledge of HTML, CSS and JavaScript, and are keen to develop their frontend development skills in a production environment by collaborating with others when necessary to review specifications
- understand the importance of accessibility and inclusive design, and are able to apply accessibility guidance with support from others
- have experience defining work focused on user needs and tasks, collaborating with user researchers and designers
- are comfortable working as part of a multidisciplinary team and can communicate ideas, problems and progress clearly
- have experience with code reviews and pairing with more experienced developers
- have experience with prototyping and testing to maintain and improve existing services, including fixing bugs and making small iterative changes

Benefits

There are many benefits of working at GDS, including:

- flexible hybrid working with flexi-time and the option to work part-time or condensed hours
- a Civil Service Pension with an average employer contribution of 28.97%
- 25 days of annual leave, increasing by a day each year up to a maximum of 30 days
- an extra day off for the King s birthday
- an in-year bonus scheme to recognise high performance
- career progression and coaching, including a training budget for personal development
- a focus on wellbeing with access to an employee assistance programme

job satisfaction from making government services easier to use and more inclusive for people across the UK

advances on pay, including for travel season tickets

death in service benefits

cycle to work scheme and facilities

access to an employee discounts scheme

10 learning days per year

volunteering opportunities (5 special leave days per year)

access to a suite of learning activities through Civil Service learning

Any move to Government Digital Service from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk

Office attendance
The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period.
DSIT does not normally offer full home working (i.e. working at home); but we do offer a variety of flexible working options (including occasionally working from home).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and

internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

The standard selection process for roles at GDS consists of:

a simple application screening process - We only ask for a CV and cover letter of up to 750 words and for you to answer an application question. Important tip - please ensure that your cover letter includes how you meet the skills and experience listed in the person specification section above

a 60 minute video interview. As part the interview process there will be a short task. Details around the task will be provided to shortlisted candidates.

Depending on how many applications we get, there might also be an extra stage before the video interview, for example a phone interview or a technical exercise.

In the event we receive a high volume of applications, we will conduct the initial sift against the lead criteria which is:

Describe a recent project or piece of work you are proud of.

In your answer, please tell us:

-what the project was and your role in it
-what went well
-what didn t go as planned or could have been improved
-what you learned from the experience, and how it influenced your approach to later work

In the Civil Service, we use Success Profiles to evaluate your skills and ability. This gives us the best possible chance of finding the right person for the job, increases performance and improves diversity and inclusivity. We ll be assessing your technical abilities, skills, experience and behaviours that are relevant to this role.

For this role we ll be assessing you against the following Civil Service Behaviours:

- delivering at pace
- working together
- communicating and Influencing

We ll also be assessing your experience and specialist technical skills against the following skills defined in the Government Digital and Data Capability Framework for the Junior Frontend Developer role:

- modern development standards
- programming and build
- prototyping
- systems design
- systems integration
- user focus
- web performance optimisation

Want to know more about who Government Digital and Data are? Click Here

Recruitment Timeline

Sift completion: Friday 24th April 2026

Panel interviews: starting from Tuesday 5th May 2026

Candidates that do not pass the interview but have demonstrated an acceptable standard may be considered for similar roles at a lower grade.

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Please note that this role requires SC clearance, which would normally need 5 years UK residency in the past 5 years. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible.

For meaningful checks to be carried out, you will need to have lived in the UK for a sufficient period of time, to enable appropriate checks to be carried out and produce a result which provides the required level of assurance. Whilst a lack of UK residency in itself is not necessarily a bar to a security clearance, and expectation of UK residency may range from 3 to 5 years. Failure to meet the residency requirements needed for the role may result in the withdrawal of provisional jobs offers.

Sponsorship

DSIT cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. DSIT holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles and this campaign does not qualify.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. Read more about prison leaver recruitment (opens in new window).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission by email: info@csc.gov.uk Or in writing: Civil Service Commission, Room G/8 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ.

Civil Service Commission

disability confident EMPLOYER